

What did you learn?

Making mistakes can be painful, both during and after. But what we sometimes forget is that with every mistake there usually comes a lesson, and with lessons comes value. It's not possible to move through life without failing or erring in myriad ways, including financially – and even if there were, I'm not always sure that that's the path I'd choose. I know for a fact that my relationship with money is better now, having spent time and effort repairing it after a crisis, than it would have been had I not made some of those mistakes. I often feel that, had I not found myself in a situation whereby I was forced to deal with my mistakes head on or else face financial ruin, I might have chugged through life constantly living a little bit beyond my means, never planning for the future, always a little bit anxious about money. I might never have learned to be proactive in looking after my financial wellbeing. The lessons we learn from making mistakes with money are as valuable as actual cash, but only if we learn to see them that way. If we allow them to become embedded into our souls, if we allow them to undermine our confidence, then they become a self-fulfilling prophecy; a never-ending cycle of errors, blame and shame.

Exercise: Lessons from your money mistakes

Take the three mistakes you jotted down earlier, and take some time to think about what they taught you. There will